



FREE GUIDE · FOR ACADEMIC MEDICAL CENTERS

The Academic Medical Center's Guide to Disposal.

Clinical care and research waste —
two worlds, one compliant program.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

Clinical plus research waste.

Academic medical centers combine hospital-scale clinical care with research — so the waste spans clinical regulated medical waste plus research biohazard, hazardous chemicals, controlled substances used in labs, and chemotherapy. Coordinating clinical and research compliance under one program is the real challenge. This guide covers every stream.

The good news

One DEA-registered partner can cover clinical and research waste alike — controlled, biohazard, RCRA-hazardous, and chemo — with non-retrievable destruction, USP 800 and RCRA handling, and audit-ready documentation. Scheduled pickup available.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training.
EPA	RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.
DEA	Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.
DOT	Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.
State	Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Controlled substances

Schedule II–V across clinical departments and research labs (DEA-registered lab use).

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired / unused Schedule II–V
- Wasted doses (clinical & research)
- Surrendered controlled stock

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-controlled meds (pharmaceutical kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · DEA — render non-retrievable, Form 222 for Schedule II transfers, Form 41 for surrendered controls, witnessed logs.

DISPOSE WITH · Controlled-substance destruction, to DEA standards.

Tip

Diversion risk makes witnessed wasting logs and a clean paper trail non-negotiable.

WASTE STREAM 02

Biohazard / regulated medical waste

Clinical red-bag plus research and animal biohazard.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Clinical blood-soaked materials
- Research & culture biohazard
- Animal-research waste (per protocol)

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Sharps (sharps kit)
- Lightly soiled everyday items
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)

THE RULE · OSHA plus your state's medical-waste rules — red bags, labeling, treatment/destruction, retained documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Biohazard mail-back kit or scheduled pickup.

Tip

Only visibly blood/OPIM-contaminated items are red-bag waste — over-classifying at volume is costly.

WASTE STREAM 03

RCRA-hazardous waste

Hazardous pharmaceutical waste and laboratory chemicals.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- P/U-listed & characteristic drugs
- Laboratory hazardous chemicals
- Reactive / ignitable waste

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-hazardous pharmaceuticals
- Controlled substances (own path)

THE RULE · EPA RCRA — identify P/U-listed and characteristic waste, segregate, and destroy to EPA standards; know your generator status.

DISPOSE WITH · RCRA-hazardous mail-back kit or pickup.

Tip

At a facility scale, generator status and segregation drive both compliance and cost.

WASTE STREAM 04

Sharps

Clinical and laboratory sharps.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Clinical needles & blades
- Laboratory sharps & pipettes
- Blood-draw sharps

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Bloody gauze (biohazard)
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)
- Non-sharp packaging

THE RULE · OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers, no overfilling, annual training.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit or scheduled pickup.

Tip

Replace containers at the fill line; high-volume sites should check daily.

WASTE STREAM 05

Trace & bulk chemotherapy (USP 800)

Trace and bulk chemotherapy from oncology and research.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Trace (RCRA-empty) chemo
- Bulk / unused hazardous drug
- USP 800 PPE

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-hazardous pharmaceuticals
- Sharps (sharps kit)

THE RULE · USP 800 and EPA RCRA — segregate trace (RCRA-empty) from bulk hazardous drug; incinerate/destroy to the required standard.

DISPOSE WITH · Trace chemo mail-back kit; bulk chemo scoped as RCRA-hazardous.

Tip

Trace (RCRA-empty) and bulk chemo follow different paths — segregate them.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The academic medical center compliance checklist.

- ☐ Controlled substances (clinical and lab) logged, non-retrievable, with Form 222/41.
- ☐ Research and clinical biohazard segregated and destroyed per protocol.
- ☐ RCRA-hazardous drugs and lab chemicals identified and segregated.
- ☐ Trace vs bulk chemo segregated per USP 800.
- ☐ Sharps standardized across clinical and lab settings.
- ☐ Audit-ready Certificates of Destruction archived.

QUESTIONS ACADEMIC CENTERS ASK

Your academic medical center questions, answered.

Can you handle both clinical and research waste?

Yes — a single coordinated program covering clinical RMW plus research biohazard, hazardous chemicals, and lab controlled substances.

How are lab controlled substances handled?

DEA-registered lab use is destroyed non-retrievable with Form 41 and witnessed logs, the same standard as clinical.

Do you handle laboratory hazardous chemicals?

Yes — RCRA-hazardous chemicals and drugs are segregated and destroyed to EPA standards.

Mail-back or pickup?

Scheduled pickup for the clinical and research volume, with mail-back where it fits.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle coordinates clinical and research waste for academic medical centers under one program — scheduled pickup with centralized records — covering controlled, biohazard, RCRA-hazardous, and chemo streams with audit-ready Certificates of Destruction.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Controlled (clinical & lab)	Controlled destruction (Form 41)
Clinical & research biohazard	Biohazard pickup / kits
Hazardous drugs & chemicals	RCRA-hazardous destruction
Sharps	Kits or pickup
Chemo (trace/bulk)	Trace kit / bulk RCRA (USP 800)

Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

Academic centers need a coordinated clinical + research program — let's scope it. Get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.

WHY ACADEMIC MEDICAL CENTERS CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order



Ready to simplify your academic medical center waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop